

Draped Team Feedback

Overall, I think the team did a great job. I think the core idea is strong and differentiated, especially for cultural garments and the combination of resale, rental, and fit-focused search information. I think the personas were also really well done. The user motivations seem very legit and as someone who has bought and sold on resale apps before, the balance between emotional attachment and value recover for clothing is well done. As far as things to improve, the main things I don't understand are the timing of implementing trust in the timeline as well as the long-term scalability of the app with the current positioning.

First, I think trust needs to be a core part of Phase 1, not something that comes later. This feels like the biggest barrier to adoption. As a user, I would immediately worry about, whether the garment is authentic and in good condition, whether I'll actually get what I paid for, and for rental whether or not I will get it in time for my event. As a seller I would be worried about the shipping / insurance costs for such an expensive garment, or in the case of renting, whether or not I can trust the renter to return my garment on time and in good condition.

Right now, I don't think those concerns are fully addressed. I would make the trust and verification system much more explicit upfront. Trust between the company, the sellers, and the buyers is by far the most important aspect in a business model like this. The app can work flawlessly, but if trust is broken, the whole thing begins to fall apart. You might want to consider a more controlled model early on, like consignment (something like a The Real Real / Rent the Runway combo), to reduce risk and build trust before moving into a fully peer-to-peer marketplace. This will allow you to verify the measurements and quality.

The other thing is that I would improve the positioning. As it was presented, it currently seems targeted at only South Asian (specifically Indian) cultural garments. That is perfectly fine, as the Indian culture both in India and within the diaspora is huge, but if the intent is specifically to be for Indian cultural garments I would lean more into that. If you plan to start with Indian culture and eventually expand to other cultures, then I would also be explicit about that in your timeline and plan and be a bit more generic on the wording.

Overall, it is a super strong concept, and definitely one of the best presentations. None of the other concepts come close to this one in terms of creativity and market need.